

GALAGA CPC — Game Manual

Objective

Pilot your fighter, destroy the alien formations, and score as many points as possible. The game advances through successive stages until all lives are lost.



The title screen alternates between point values and the Hall of Fame.

Starting the game

1. Start the Amstrad CPC or emulator with the game disk inserted.
2. At the Locomotive BASIC Ready prompt, type `RUN"galaga.bas` and press Enter.
3. The intro screen appears. Press **Space** or wait 10 seconds for the game to load.
4. At the title screen, choose a difficulty with left/right, then press **1** (or **Space** / joystick **Fire 1**) for a one-player game, or **2** for a two-player game.

Controls

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Move left	Left arrow or <code>O</code>	Left
Move right	Right arrow or <code>P</code>	Right
Fire / select	<code>Space</code>	Fire 1
Pause / resume	<code>H</code>	—
1-player / 2-player game (title screen)	<code>1</code> / <code>2</code>	—

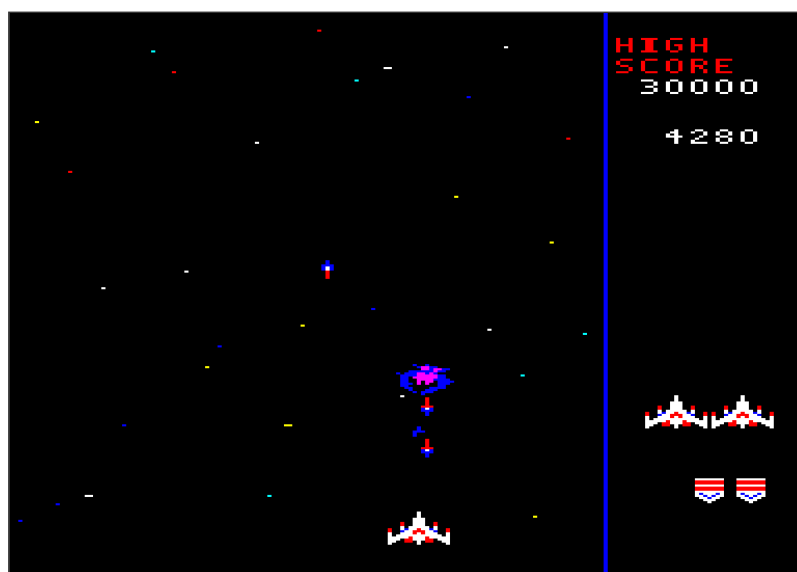
Hold the fire button for repeated shots. While paused, press `H` again to resume.

Difficulty

The default is **Medium**. Choose **Easy**, **Medium**, **Hard**, or **Hardest** on the title screen with the left/right arrows, **O** / **P**, or the joystick. **Easy** preserves the game's original behavior. From **Medium** onward, each group includes enemies that enter quickly from above and take their formation positions; center and lower-side entry patterns remain in the mix. Higher settings also bring attacks and firing to earlier stages and add more firing enemies. The pressure increases further as you progress through the stages.

Stages and enemies

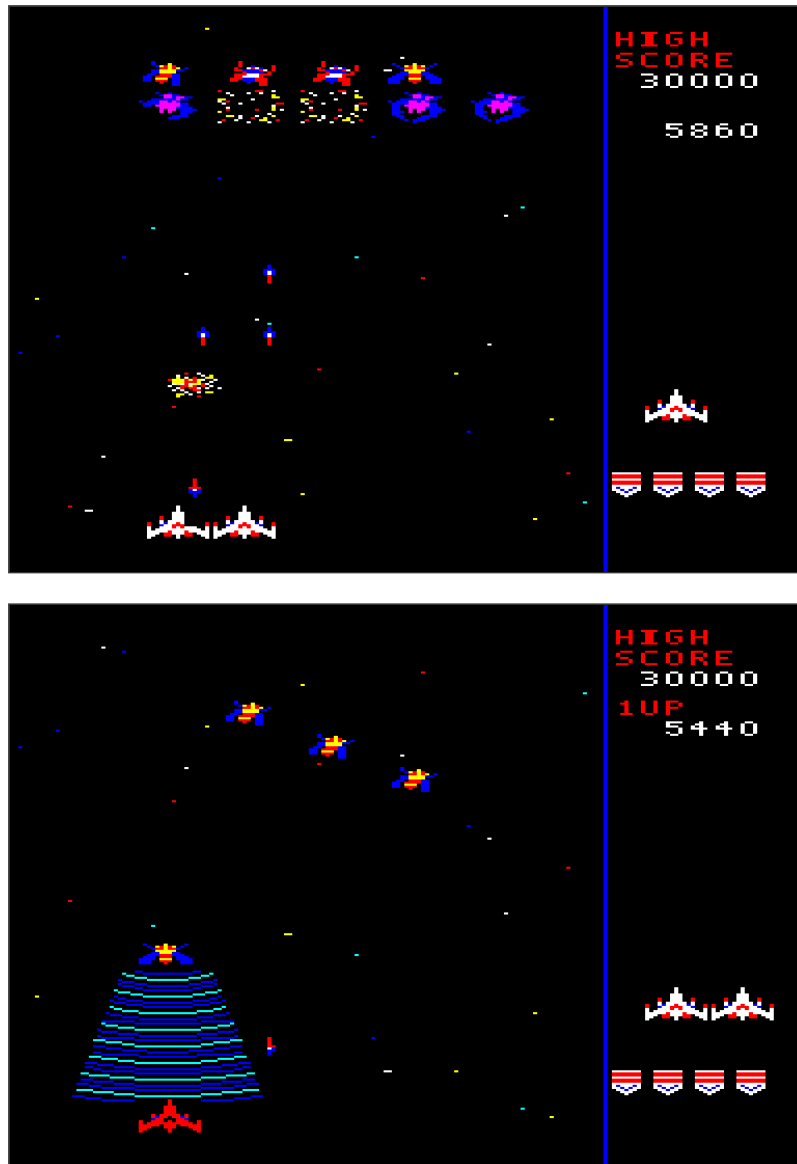
- Regular stages start with 14 enemies and add two on each successive regular stage, up to 28. Bonus stages do not change this count. Entry groups arrive one at a time: the next group starts after the previous group has completed its entry. Destroy every enemy to advance.
- Enemies already in formation can attack while later groups are still entering. The chance of an attack at each interval increases with the selected difficulty.
- Enemies that fire while entering have two extra firing opportunities, each with about a 10% chance on Easy, 20% on Medium, 35% on Hard, and 50% on Hardest.
- The screen allows up to 2 simultaneous enemy shots on Easy, 3 on Medium, 4 on Hard, and 5 on Hardest, plus one more from stage 10 onward.
- Every fourth stage, starting at stage 3 (3, 7, 11, ...), is a bonus stage. Hit as many targets as possible before it ends.
- On Easy, one random enemy from each entry group fires on stages 6–11, two on stages 12–17, and three from stage 18 onward. Higher difficulties enable more shooters earlier.
- Diving enemies drop two bombs, and a third from stage 5 onward.
- During dives, each enemy randomly chooses its horizontal speed: about one third are 33% faster, one third are 33% slower, and the rest move at normal speed. Faster divers may briefly overshoot to the other side of the player.
- From stage 40 onward, enemy shots also travel diagonally.
- Enemy point values are shown on the title screen. Scores vary by enemy type and whether it is destroyed in formation or while attacking.



Watch for enemy shots and diving attacks.

Lives and the second fighter

You start with three lives. Extra lives are awarded as your score increases. If Boss Galaga captures your fighter, destroying the Boss before capture is complete can release it. If capture completes, you continue with one fewer life; when the captured fighter returns, you gain a dual-fighter formation with increased firepower. A collision can cost one of the two fighters.



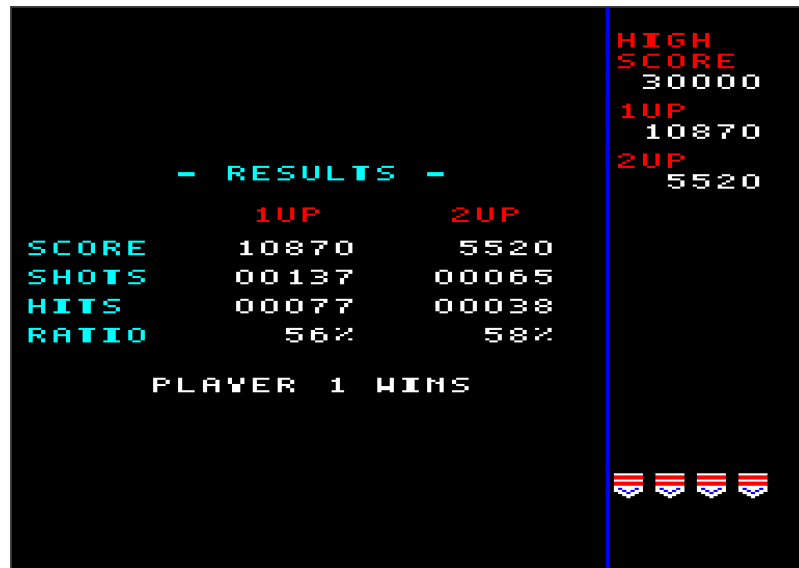


Two-player game

Players take turns on the same controls. When a player loses a life, the other player takes over and continues exactly where they left off, with their own stage, enemy formation, captured fighter, lives and score. A player who loses the last life sees **GAME OVER** and the other player plays on alone.

When both players are out, a results screen compares their score, shots, hits and hit-miss ratio side by side and names the winner by score (or a draw). Then each player whose score qualifies for the Top 5 enters initials, player 1 first.





Score and entering initials

If your final score qualifies for the Top 5, enter three initials:

- Left / down: previous letter.
- Right / up: next letter.
- **Space** or Fire 1: confirm the letter and move to the next position.

The Top 5 scores are saved to the disk and remain available after restarting. Keep the game disk in the drive while entering initials. If saving fails, the game displays a warning.





On-screen information

- **1UP / 2UP:** each player's score; the label of the player now playing blinks. 2UP appears only in a two-player game.
- **HIGH SCORE:** the highest saved score.
- **Ships along the bottom:** remaining lives.
- **Stage badges:** badges valued at 1, 5, 10, 20, 30, and 50 combine to show the current stage. For example, stage 4 shows four 1-point badges, stage 5 shows one 5-point badge, and stage 6 shows one 5-point badge plus one 1-point badge.

Tips

- Move horizontally and keep firing, while watching the position of enemy shots.
- In bonus stages, focus on hitting as many targets as possible.
- From stage 40 onward, account for the sideways movement of enemy fire.
- Press **H** to pause whenever needed.